TOPIC 1 · FUNDAMENTALS OF MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT
LAB 2 THEME · WORD TO POWERPOINT AND OUTLOOK

Lab 2 — Create the Cross-App Maintenance Update

Maps to	LO1: integrate verified Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook outputs
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook · OneDrive
Mock data	data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx
Course	GenAI for Engineers · v2.3
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-2

Goal

Continue the verified operations brief from Lab 1. You will turn it into an initial PowerPoint update, then prepare an Outlook reply to a synthetic maintenance thread. You will test how grounding differs between an attached file, a chat transcript and a reviewed summary, and reconcile the same facts across all four apps.

What You Will Do

Continue the verified operations brief from Lab 1. You will turn it into an initial PowerPoint update, then prepare an Outlook reply to a synthetic maintenance thread. You will test how grounding differs between an attached file, a chat transcript and a reviewed summary, and reconcile the same facts across all four apps.

What You Will Build

Northstar_Initial_Update.pptx, an unsent Outlook draft and an Evidence_Log with Excel, Word, PowerPoint and Outlook figures reconciled.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac is recommended; save working copies to your assigned OneDrive course folder with AutoSave on. Do not overwrite the supplied input.
- Download this whole lab folder. All files are synthetic; work-genai is your own learner output folder.
- Your Lab 1 workbook and Word brief.

Data note

Northstar Water Services is a fictional water-pipe maintenance and service company. All service hubs, staff and work orders are synthetic. Use the fixed reporting date 2026-09-30; missing facts remain UNKNOWN. Proposals do not change real assignments. Training email drafts are never sent.

Steps

Step 1. Open your Lab 1 Word brief and cleaned workbook. Read the synthetic email thread quoted in the Step 4 prompt. It asks for a portfolio update, not authorisation to reassign technicians.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
From this selected verified Northstar Water Services operations brief, extract a handoff table with reporting date, filter scope, total, closed, cancelled, backlog, overdue, unassigned backlog and recorded cost. Separate facts, proposed next actions and open decisions. Keep every value traceable to the supplied brief.
```

Step 2. Open data/templates/Northstar_Management_Deck_Template.pptx in PowerPoint and save as Northstar_Initial_Update.pptx. For this initial update use four slides by keeping the first four layout slides and deleting the remaining unused template slides. Open Copilot and select your Word brief with Reference a file; if the command is unavailable, paste the reviewed brief into the prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Using this verified Northstar Word brief, create a four-slide initial update: scope and
portfolio; backlog and overdue work; current assignments and proposed actions; decision
required. Use the existing white/navy/blue design. Preserve all verified metrics. Add
source/date notes. Do not invent completed work, savings or approved reassignment.
```

Step 3. Review all four slides. Check status definitions, units and date, and correct any invented claim. Record the reconciliation in the Evidence_Log sheet: one row per claim and a source link. This is the bridge between app outputs; app chats are not automatically shared.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Audit these four Northstar Water Services slides against the selected verified operations
brief. For each numeric claim give the source, date and scope; flag unsupported
service-restoration, safety, customer-impact or approval claims. Propose corrections without
changing the checked values.
```

Step 4. In Outlook create a new training draft addressed to operations.manager@example.invalid with subject DRAFT - Northstar maintenance update - review required. Do not send. Paste the synthetic thread into the draft or use it as quoted context; Copilot summarises the supplied text, not a real mailbox thread. Open Copilot > Draft with Copilot; UI names may differ.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
OUTLOOK COPILOT:
Draft a concise reply to the synthetic thread quoted below, using the verified Northstar brief
and these checked metrics. State the 30 September 2026 scope, backlog/overdue findings,
proposed next actions and the decision requested. Explain that assignments are unapproved
proposals. Do not claim the attachments have been sent. Keep as a draft.

THREAD (synthetic, do not send):
2026-09-29 09:00 Operations manager: Please prepare the 30 September portfolio snapshot; show
open work by site, category and current assignment. 2026-09-29 10:15 Supervisor: Check overdue
jobs before proposing reassignment. Available hours are planning inputs, not approval.
2026-09-30 08:30 Analyst: The source export is in the workbook. No new assignment has been
approved. Please produce a Word brief and a short PowerPoint update, then prepare a draft
reply.
```

Step 5. If your Outlook offers reference attachments, attach the verified Word brief and choose it as context. Otherwise paste the reviewed metrics into the drafting prompt. Replace any placeholder summary with exact checked values; inspect recipients, subject, tone and attachment names. Save only the draft and a local TXT copy of its reviewed body.

Step 6. Ask Word Copilot to compare your pasted slide/email summaries with the brief, then perform the same comparison yourself. Add the cross-app prompt log entries manually. Keep all four source links with the reconciliation record; any mismatch must be fixed before the skill labs.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Compare these pasted PowerPoint and Outlook summaries with this verified Word brief. List
inconsistent figures, status definitions, dates, owner claims or approved-action wording. Do
not resolve a conflict by guessing. Return a discrepancy table with source and correction
needed.
```

Sample Prompts

Use the app labelled for each prompt (or adapt it). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. Use the linked prompts web page for one-click Copy buttons.

Copy-ready prompts: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-2

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Scope	State actual source, report date and selected scope before acting.
2	Verify	Explain the source/formula checks and preserve unknowns and original records.

Test It

Check	Expected result
Four apps	Excel Checks, Word brief, four-slide update and unsent Outlook draft share the same date and values.
Cross-app grounding	Named file or pasted verified evidence is provided in each app; no assumed shared chat.
Draft boundary	example.invalid recipient; nothing sent and no assignment approved.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot find the source	Use the app file picker to select the actual OneDrive file. A typed local path or a different app chat is not shared context. If needed copy only the verified snapshot into the current app.
A total disagrees with Control	Clear dashboard filters to All, check table extent and duplicate IDs, recalculate, then compare definitions and reporting date. Reconcile before continuing.
The named feature is missing	Confirm the correct assigned account, English display language and app version. Use the stated manual practice route; record feature unavailable. This is not evidence that a native skill ran.

Challenge

Repeat the task for one different site and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?